

CHAPTER 4

ARRANGED MARRIAGE: WHY IT CAN SOMETIMES WORK

From ancient tribal unions to marriage in the 21st century, society has been figuring out partnership for thousands of years. As long as people have been living, eating, trading, fighting and procreating, a union between individuals has existed in one form or another. The fact that the human race lives on in perpetuity is solid proof. But the love marriage—the marriage that stems from those initial feelings of adulation and infatuation and all too often the blatant disregards common sense—is relatively new.

A long time ago, in a galaxy not so far away, marriage was a way of shoring up important alliances and expanding the family labor force. If you wanted to stay warm and ward off predators, two was better than one, and a whole tribe was better than two. It made sense to have 19 kids because you knew eight were going to die, and the rest were going to be in the fields pulling up root vegetables for dinner. The more children you had, the better your chances of keeping the family alive and robust. Compare that to today, when kids are often parasitic creatures taking refuge in their parents' basements well into their adult years.